

They must weigh the subsoil, however, for the present situation has its "ifs," of course. But it is a more sound situation than we had in March. The first lopping off of speculative issues has been accomplished. Sound issues have recovered somewhat. It is just the natural movement of the pendulum, which swung too far because men were too full of hope.

The stock-market operator—the speculator—is a dealer in realities. When he reads his paper in the morning, he is fitting the trend of world events to sudden sallies or long-swing movements. He interprets the news into movement, up or down.

Business men may well take a lesson from the speculator. Those who, like him, look behind each word and sentence for the reason therefor, or the possible effects thereof, are leaders in their fields.

I took my son to Niagara Falls one day. We looked down into the cataract, and I pointed to the water, flowing back towards the falls.

"See, son," I said. "That water is flowing up hill: That water is defying nature's law seemingly. Why?"

And then we analyzed how the great force of that water hurtling over the falls forced that movement up and down and back, but finally down, as natural law decrees.

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*I do not blame less-informed men for pulling in their horns when the bubble bursts.*

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There are many great forces working night and day to undermine our best judgments, to put to the test our most careful deliberations! They are the "ifs": debt settlements, crops, foreign exchange, British labor troubles, and so on! Each has its place and each its possibility.

Everything may be progressing smoothly—upward—when a sudden upheaval in Russia, in France, in Poland, a